

Meta pays for running reactors' output

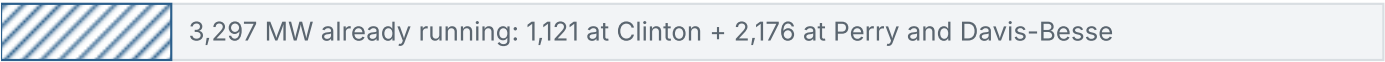
Signal	Meta signed 20-year contracts for 3,760 megawatts (MW) of nuclear output, our sum of 3,297 MW running plus 463 MW of planned uprates (upgrades that add output): Constellation's Clinton in Illinois (signed June 3, 2025; 20 years from June 2027) and Vistra plants in Ohio and Pennsylvania (signed January 9, 2026).
Read	Meta pays for the output and counts it as its clean power. Clinton's subsidy ends mid-2027; NPR Illinois reports the deal keeps the plant running beyond that. Vistra adds 433 MW of uprates; its CEO says Meta's commitment gives "the certainty needed to invest."
Cost	Meta pays Constellation and Vistra undisclosed prices. Investment bank Jefferies puts Clinton at about \$70 per megawatt-hour (MWh), \$20 above Illinois' market rate from 2028. At Jefferies' estimated price, Clinton costs Meta about \$651 million a year in total, \$186 million of it above market (our estimates).

The simple version

Clinton's owner is a landlord whose subsidy from Illinois power customers is ending; Meta is a 20-year tenant who never moves in. The power keeps flowing into the grid as before, and Meta buys the right to count it as its clean power. Meta's head of global energy says it invests in nuclear "because it provides clean, reliable power."

Only one megawatt in eight is new

463 MW new (12%): 30 at Clinton + 433 at Vistra 3,760 MW under contract



The deals, in order

1. Jun 3, 2025 Clinton signed Constellation's Illinois plant plus its uprate. Price not disclosed.	2. Jan 9, 2026 Vistra signed Perry and Davis-Besse in Ohio, plus uprates there and at Beaver Valley, Pennsylvania.	3. Jun 2027 Meta pays Illinois customers' subsidy for Clinton ends; Meta's 20 years begin, running to 2047.	4. By 2034 Uprates done All of Vistra's uprates are online, per Vistra, completing its 2,609 MW.
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The alternative, side by side

Clinton with Meta's contract		Clinton without Meta	
Who pays	Meta	Who pays	Illinois customers
Above market	About \$186 million a year (est.)	Old subsidy cap	Up to \$235 million a year
Plants covered	Clinton	Plants covered	Clinton and Quad Cities
Term	20 years from June 2027	Term	Ends mid-2027
Plant's future	Runs past mid-2027	Plant's future	Our read: new subsidy, or closure

Output a year, est. × \$70 Jefferies price × \$20 Jefferies premium Output = 1,121 MW × 8,760 hours × 94.7%: the 2025 full-power share of Constellation's fleet (two plants excluded), a stand-in for Clinton.

9.3 million MWh **\$651 million total** **\$186 million over market**

Who else

Who	Counterparty	Size	Term	New or existing	The read
Meta	Constellation, Clinton (Illinois)	1,121 MW + 30 MW	20 yrs	Existing	Needed no regulatory approval; the plant also won an NRC (Nuclear Regulatory Commission) license renewal.
Meta	Vistra, Perry and Davis-Besse (Ohio)	2,176 MW + 433 MW	20 yrs	Existing plus uprates	Per WNN (Feb 2026), Davis-Besse deliveries start December 2027; four uprates follow, one a year.
Amazon	Talen, Susquehanna (Pennsylvania)	1,920 MW	Through 2042	Existing	Began wired straight to the plant; moved onto the public grid after spring 2026.
Amazon	Vistra, Comanche Peak (Texas)	Up to 1,200 MW	20 yrs	Existing	The same seller signs a second tech giant, for a Texas plant.
Meta	Oklo (Ohio)	Up to 1,200 MW	Not disclosed	New	The only new-build reactors here; Meta's nuclear deals total up to 6.6 GW, new and existing, by 2035.

What reaches PJM-area power bills

Meta's Vistra plants sit on PJM, the grid operator for Ohio, Pennsylvania and nearby states. PJM runs a yearly auction that pays plants to be available when needed, called capacity. Power customers in the PJM area pay the result through their bills.

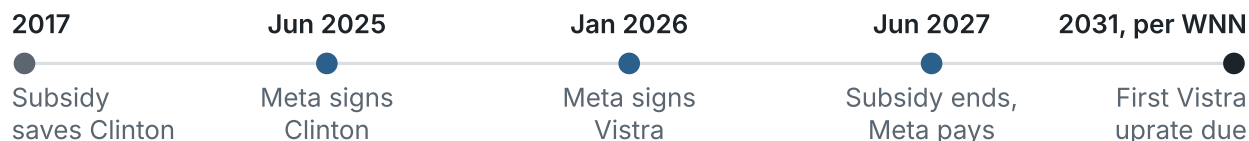
Price, 2028 to 2029	\$325 per MW of capacity per day, set in July 2026
Per MW, per year	About \$118,625 (estimate: \$325 × 365 days), before utilities pass it through
Supply gap	The auction came up 6,831 MW short of PJM's reliability target
Next auction	December 2026, for 2029 to 2030

What each side leaves out

Side	Claim	Omission	The test
The buyer	Pays "the full costs" of its data centers' energy so "consumers don't bear these expenses"; has added "nearly 28 GW of new energy" to grids (GW: gigawatts, a thousand MW each).	Of the 2,609 MW it bought from Vistra, 2,176 MW is output already on the grid.	Does PJM's December 2026 auction still fall short of its reliability target?
The seller	"More than 2,600 MW," with power "flowing to the PJM grid exactly as it does today."	The price Meta pays and the cost of the uprates are not disclosed.	Does a contract price appear in Vistra's filings or earnings reports?
The grid watchdog (Monitoring Analytics, PJM's market monitor)	As of January 2026, forecast data center demand accounted for \$21.3 billion, 45% of the \$47.2 billion cost of PJM's last three auctions.	Contracts like Meta's pay for 463 MW of uprates that add supply.	How many uprate MW reach PJM auctions by 2034?

The twist: same plants, same grid, new payer

Vistra says the output keeps "flowing to the PJM grid exactly as it does today" (May 2026). Illinois customers have subsidized Clinton since 2017. That subsidy ends mid-2027; NPR Illinois reports Meta's deal keeps the plant running beyond that.



The everyday version

Big companies routinely sign long contracts for clean power: 55.9 GW of deals in 2025, and Meta, Amazon, Google and Microsoft signed 49% of them. Meta and Amazon alone took 20.4 GW, about 36% of the total (our estimate), including 4.7 GW of nuclear. Most of that is wind and solar.

Where it breaks: wind and solar deliver when the weather allows; a reactor runs around the clock, and it costs more. Jefferies puts Clinton as much as \$15 per MWh above regional wind contracts.

Three questions for an executive

How many MWh a year of your power use must be clean around the clock, not only when wind blows?

Then: price that share at nuclear's premium over wind; buy wind for the rest.

What premium per MWh would you pay to lock in clean power for 20 years, against the \$20 above market Jefferies estimates for Meta?

Then: if your answer is well below that, expect to be outbid for this supply and buy shorter contracts.

If you buy power in the PJM area, how many dollars a year of your bill are capacity charges, at \$325 per MW per day?

Then: if material, fix your power price before the December 2026 auction sets the next one.

What to watch

Dec 2026 Perry deliveries to Meta are due (unconfirmed as of Oct 5). On time confirms Meta is paying for running output now; a delay or restructuring breaks it.

Mid-2027 Illinois' subsidy for Clinton ends. Clinton running with no new state support confirms NPR Illinois' report that the deal keeps it running; new Illinois support breaks it.

Researched by NodeJ Deep Research. For the full research report, write to julian@nodej.ai.